FEATURE IDEATION

Ask Caboodle

Natural-language questions, answered from your own Caboodle data.

What we're building, how it works, what it won't do, and how we'd phase it.

What it is

Ask Caboodle is a **natural-language layer over Caboodle's own data**.

- You type a question; it answers from your data.
- It sits on top of the reports and dashboards you already use.
- Every answer links back to the source records.
- It doesn't invent anything. If it can't answer, it says so.

What we're going to do

- Replace the **hunt for reports** with asking a question.
- Start with the **data and reports you already have**.
- Let users **save the questions** they use often.
- Respect **brand scope and module subscription** from the start.
- Eventually, let users **act on answers**, not just read them.

How it's going to work

1. You **ask** in plain English.
2. It works out **what you mean**: matching names to real records, and finding which module the data lives in.
3. It checks **what you're allowed to see**: your brand, and the modules you subscribe to.
4. It builds a **structured plan**, and trusted code turns that into a **read-only query**.
5. You get a **short answer** with a link to the source records. Charts and tables on request.
6. It stays inside limits: a row cap, a timeout, and **"I can't answer that"** when the data isn't there.

Two kinds of result

Where	What it is	Stays current?
In the conversation	A snapshot of the answer at that moment	No, it records what you saw
Saved or pinned	The **query** is stored, not the result	Yes, it re-runs and refreshes

Saving keeps the *question*, not the data, so a saved or pinned chart is always live, not frozen at the time you asked.

What it will not do

- It won't answer from **outside Caboodle**.
- It won't **make up an answer** when data is missing.
- Phase 1 won't **create or change** any data. It's read-only.
- It won't replace the **tracker or the email workflow**.
- It won't give a brand access to **modules they don't pay for**.

What you'll be able to ask

Ask about anything in the data you already have, across every module.

Area	You could ask
Sales & distribution	Cases by month, top SKUs, who's buying, which stores stopped ordering
Promotions & spend	What's running, what's unsubmitted, what went over budget
Reviews & status	Upcoming reviews, who hasn't submitted, what's awaiting a response
Assortment & pricing	Which banners carry a SKU, margins, missing prices
Stores & geography	Active stores, new and dropped stores, white-space opportunities
Dashboards	Stores in, reviews due, active promos, "what needs my attention today?"

THE PLAN

Four phases

Read first, then personalise, then act, then extend.

Phase 1: Ask

Natural-language Q&A over existing data, reports, and a saved library.

- Ask across the modules and reports you already have.
- Short answer first; charts and tables on request.
- **Save a question** to a personal library so it keeps refreshing.
- Export any answer to feed an existing upload.
- Read-only, brand-scoped, gated by subscription.

Phase 2: Pin

Put the answers you care about onto a dashboard.

- Pin a saved question or a single metric.
- Arrange your own dashboard, Metabase-style.
- Refreshes automatically; no re-asking.
- Still read-only.

Which KPIs would you pin first?

Phase 3: Act

CRUD: create, update, and remove through Ask Caboodle.

- **Create**: draft a promotion from a target price or margin.
- **Update**: apply the item-status reconciliation, or update a status.
- **Remove**: retire or clear records you no longer need.
- Every write goes through the same permissions and validation as the UI.

This is where "build me a promo from 40% margin" finally lands.

Phase 4: Extend

Broaden the reach and the intelligence.

- More data domains: SPINS, Distributor APL, Trade Spend Roll-up.
- Scheduled digests and anomaly alerts.
- Shared and team-level libraries.
- Predictive and assistive planning.

The phases at a glance

Phase	Capability	Nature
1: Ask	Natural-language Q&A over existing data, reports, and a saved library	Read-only
2: Pin	Pin saved answers and metrics to a personal dashboard	Read-only
3: Act	CRUD: create, update, remove through Ask Caboodle	Writes data
4: Extend	More domains, digests, alerts, shared libraries, predictive	Expand

What we need to figure out

Problem	Why it's hard
Joined data model	Distributor sales, assortment, stores and geography aren't linked yet.
Precomputed results	Promo and spend figures are calculated on the fly today.
Data quality	Known distributor calculations and store duplicates must be fixed first.
Gating & billing	We need a clear rule for modules, cross-module questions, and cost.

ASK CABOODLE

Let's dig in

Does the four-phase shape feel right, and where should we start?